Antichrist

Purpose: *To identify the person and principle of antichrist.*

Centred on: *Jesus is Christ and anyone who turns people from Jesus or attempts to occupy the place of Jesus is putting themselves in the place of Christ and is antichrist. Jesus only is our guide and anything and everything that scatters from him is antichrist.*

1 John 1… John heard, saw, and handled the love, forgiveness, light and joy of the Word of life. He walked in fellowship with God and longed for others to experience the love and joy of Jesus. This motivated and qualified him to identify the antichrist.

1 John 2:18… There is an Antichrist that is a singular power or individual identified as "the Antichrist." In addition to "the Antichrist" there are "many antichrists." Therefore antichrist is not just a singular person or power but is also a spirit or experience that is held by "many" individual people.

1 John 2:22…If you turn away from Jesus/God and deny Him you personally individually take on the spirit of antichrist—you are against Christ.

Matthew 12:30…If we are not with Christ we are against Christ and we scatter away from Christ. This is antichrist.

Acts 20:30…Another way we scatter from Christ is by drawing people to ourselves instead of to Jesus. (Note that the immediate context of this verse is apostasy in the church).

2 Thessalonians 2:3-7…The man of sin is "the Antichrist"—a person who scatters from Christ by putting himself in the place of Christ to be worshipped as Christ. (Note verse 7: the apostasy leading to "the antichrist" was already at work in Paul's day but was held back by the power of civil Rome). Like Judas, the "man of sin" is called the "son of perdition." He has a "religious/follower of Jesus" guise. (John 17:12).

Now let's look at a prophecy of history of the end of Pagan Rome and the rising of the little horn…with TEN IDENTIFYING CHARACTERISTICS.

Daniel 7:8…Antichrist/little horn in Daniel 7 —(1) Rose after 476 A.D. (2) small beginnings (3) rose in Europe (4) rooted out 3 kingdoms (5) mans wisdom at the head (6) mouth speaking great things.

Daniel 7:22, 24… (7)This power is to continue until Jesus returns. It is (8) different from the previous powers as it was primarily religious rather than civil (#1 & #4 repeated)

Daniel 7:25… (9)It would persecute God's people/true church (10) would attempt to change God's law (11) would reign with civil authority for 1260 years (#6 repeated).

Isaiah 14:12-14… Lucifer/satan wants to be in the place of the Most High.

2 Corinthians 11:2-4; 2 Corinthians 13-15… satan uses a religious guise to deceive people and lead them away from Christ to worship him.

2 Thessalonians 2:8-12… antichrist/satan deceives those who (1) do not receive the love of the truth (2) who believe a lie (3) and who have pleasure in unrighteousness. (Note: Only fellowship with Jesus, the way the truth and the life can take antichrist out of our hearts and finally destroy it forever).

Appeal

Friends why would satan put forth so much effort to counterfeit the gospel and Jesus Christ? Why would he want to sit in the place of God?

Why does he try to get as many human beings as he possibly can to scatter from Christ?

The reason is that Jesus Christ is so good, so true so attractive that all who behold Him will be drawn to Him. The love of Christ is pure, undiluted, selfless love for every person on planet earth. Satan knows this. He knows the power of the gospel. Only things of real value are worth counterfeiting. And Jesus is priceless. No person or system of religion can replace God's love for you. Embrace God's love for you and let go of the lie. Through antichrist satan is deceiving the world with counterfeit religion, but when you experience the real joy of Jesus you will not be deceived. Amen!

Defend it

The topic of the antichrist can be misunderstood in part because of the interpretation of the word "anti" which means *both* "against" and "instead of." In addition it is not always realized that the Bible allows for personal individual antichrist identification in addition to "the antichrist" identification.

American Dictionary of the English Language

Noah Webster-1828

"Anti [Greek see ante] A preposition signifying against, opposite, contrary, or in place of."

Etymology-Wiktionary

Conversion of the prefix *anti-* to an adjective, from Latin *anti*, from Ancient Greek ἀντί (*antí*, "against, opposite, instead of"), from (*ánta*), from Proto-Indo-European **anti* (compare Hittite hanza 'front', Latin *ante* 'before', Tocharian A *ánt(e)* 'forehead', Gothic *and* 'throughout', Lithuanian *añt* 'on, in order to', Ossetian *ändä* 'outside', Sanskrit *ántas* 'end, boundary').

The Free Dictionary by Farlex

anti-

prefix

1. against; opposing

2. opposite to

3. rival; false

4. counteracting, inhibiting, or neutralizing

Summary:

Introduction	Mist of Crisis (Issues)	Conclusion
Revelation 12: 17.	**Worship**: Rev 13: 4, 8, 12, 15 Rev 14: 7, 9, 11	***Revelation 14: 12.***
Commandments of God.	**Obedience**: Rev 13: 4, 5-6, 14 Rev 14: 7	Commandments of God.
Testimony of Jesus.		Faith of Jesus.

In the previous studies, we learned about the gospel and the Holy Spirit. Then we studied about the law of God. Now we are learning that in the final crisis there is going to be an attack against the new covenant! The new covenant is God writing his law on our heart and mind. And revelation is saying there will be a full frontal satanic attack on Gods new covenant!
Satan is going to work through **three actors** to make it impossible for Gods new covenant promise to be fulfilled in your life.

The Three Actors:

Revelation 12: 17…	The Dragon.
Revelation 13: 1…	The Sea Beast.
Revelation 13: 11…	The Earth Beast.

Note the counterfeit qualities in the final crisis: (counterfeit trinity).

The Dragon…	God the Father.
The Sea Beast…	God the Son.
The Earth Beast…	God the Holy Spirit.

These three conspire to take worship, obedience and faith from the true God!

In ***Revelation 1: 4-5***, God is depicted as triune.

The Dragon: (God the Father).

God has three angels message (Rev 14: 6-9).	Dragon has three unclean spirits like frogs (Rev 16: 13).
God has a throne (Rev 3: 21; 20: 11).	The Dragon has a throne (Rev 2: 13).
God has wrath (Rev 14: 19).	The dragon has wrath (Rev 12: 12).
God has a woman (Rev 12: 1).	The Dragon has a woman (Rev 17: 1-4).
God has a seal (Rev 9: 4).	The Dragon has a mark (Rev 13: 17).
God has a city (Rev 21: 8-New Jerusalem).	The Dragon has a city (Rev 14:8; 16:19; 17:1; 18:24-Babylon).

The Sea Beast: (God the Son).

Jesus began his ministry at his baptism *coming up out of the water*. How does the sea beast begin his ministry?

Now look at **Revelation 13: 2**…Notice that the Dragon gives his authority and throne to the sea beast. In **Revelation 3: 21-22**…we see that Jesus shares his father's throne. So God shares his throne with the Son and the Dragon shares his throne with sea beast.

Revelation 13: 3… If something is wounded to death and the deadly wound is healed what do we call that? A resurrection perhaps?

- So this beast begins its ministry coming up out of the water.
- This beast gets its power from the Dragon.
- This beast receives a death and a resurrection.

If this is not a counterfeit of Jesus Christ then I don't know what is? Furthermore, the ministry of Jesus lasted 3.5 years. We find in Revelation 13: 5, the sea beast was also given a period of 3.5 years (42months) to do his work.

In summary, Satan is thinking he cannot allow the new covenant to be fulfilled in people's lives. We know from previous studies how we obtain the spirit of God and how we receive the new covenant…By believing an accepting Jesus! So Satan therefore comes up with something that looks like Jesus, talks like Jesus and even acts like Jesus but **Isn't Jesus.** Unfortunately people will put their faith there and will not experience the new covenant. All the while they will be religious and think they are following Jesus.

The Earth Beast: (God the Holy Spirit).

Revelation 13: 12… **Question:** What does the Earth Beast do?

Answer: The Earth Beast point's people back to the Sea Beast.

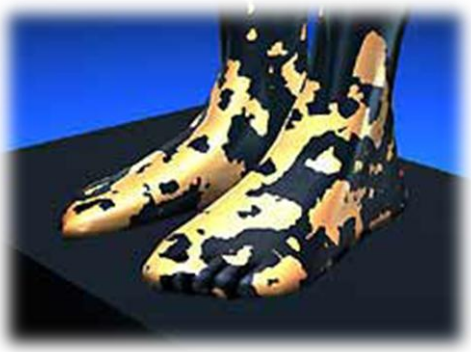
Notice the similarity here with the role of the Holy Spirit in pointing people back to Jesus.

Revelation 13: 13… The Earth Beast performs great signs, even makes fire come down from heaven.

Question: How did the Holy Spirit come at Pentecost?

Answer: Signs and Wonders and with tongues of fire! **(Acts 2: 3).**

Satan's counterfeit plan is so tremendous that he is able to deceive the whole world **(Rev 12: 9).**



Part 2: (**Please note**: A thorough understanding of *Daniel Chapter 2* is essential prior to progression at this point).

Daniel 7: 1-2…What does the winds represent? And what does the Great Sea represent?

Winds: Strife/Commotion/Winds of war **(Jeremiah 4: 11-13; 25: 31-33; 49: 36, 37; Zechariah 7: 14).**

Waters/Sea: Inhabited area/Peoples/Multitudes/Nations **(revelation 17: 15).**

Winds.
The "winds" of Daniel, which strove upon the great sea, causing four beasts—or empires—to emerge, represented those movements, diplomatic, warlike, political, or otherwise, that were to shape the history of the period.
The "four winds," being from the four points of the compass, doubtless represent political activity in various parts of the earth (Jer. 49:36; Dan. 8:8; 11:4; Zech. 2:6; 6:5).
Great sea.
No specific body of water, such as the Mediterranean Sea, need be inferred. The sea is here symbolic of the nations of the world—the "great sea" of humanity in all ages (see Rev. 17:15; Isa. 17:12; Jer. 46:7)

Daniel 7: 3-4…**Question:** What do these four great beasts represent?



Answer: According to ***Daniel 7: 17, 23,*** we find that Beasts represent Kings/Kingdoms.

Now, In ***Daniel 2: 38***, Daniel identifies the first kingdom as Babylon. Once you have a starting point, it's not hard to get to the ending point.

Question: How long did Babylon reign for?
Answer: From 605 B. C. – 539 B. C.

Daniel 7: 5…Notice the mention of it being "raised up on one side" This kingdom was an alliance between the Medes and the Persians. These two kingdoms joined forces with one another to overthrow three kingdoms…Babylon, Lydia and Egypt. Thus explaining the "three ribs in its mouth" History tells us that the Persians were the dominate of the two.

Question: How long did this kingdom rule?
Answer: 539 B. C. – 331 B. C.

Daniel 7: 6… The Medes and Persians were ultimately overthrown by the Grecian empire. Interestingly, the Leopard is an appropriate symbol for this empire as Alexander the Great conquered the then known world within the time of his early thirties. The rapid conquest of the entire then known world is fitting with the description of a Leopard with "four wings of a bird". This beast also has four heads, which according to historians; at the death of Alexander the Great the Grecian empire was handed over to his four leading Generals.

- Cassander - Macedonia & Greece, lying to the West.
- Lysimachus - Thrace & Northern parts of Asia Minor.
- Seleucus - Syria, Babylon & the rest of Alexander's dominions in the East.
- Ptolemy - Egypt, Palestine and Arabia, Southern portions of the Empire.

Daniel 7: 7… This fourth beast represents the Pagan Roman Empire that ruled from 168 B.C. – A. D. 476. Note the iron teeth, as these correspond to the iron legs mentioned in Daniel 2. Furthermore, note the identification of Ten Horns.

Daniel 7: 24… We see the Ten Horns as being identified as Ten Kings/Kingdoms "who shall arise from Rome" and for future reference, "another shall arise after them" and "He shall be different from the first ones." **(For further details, see appendix).**

In summary we find the successive empires of:

- Babylon.
- Medo- Persia.
- Greece.
- Rome.
- Ten dividing nations of Rome.
- Final Kingdom (Little kingdom/different from the previous).

Daniel 7: 8… In this verse we have 5 identifying characteristics.



- A little Horn.
- Coming up among them.
- Plucked out three horns by the roots. *
- Eyes.
- Mouth.

So a ***little Horn/kingdom*** arises from ***amongst the ten nations of the divided Roman Empire*** that ***plucks up three kingdoms*** when it comes to power and it has the ***eyes like the eyes of a man*** (It has man/human influence at its head). And it has a ***mouth speaking pompous words***.

* History clearly records that three of the original ten pagan kingdoms of Rome were indeed "plucked up by the roots." When the Roman Empire ended in A.D. 476, a struggle began for control of the ten remaining parts of the empire. On one side were three of the pagan tribes: the **Heruli**, the **Vandals**, and the **Ostrogoths**. On the other were the Bishop of Rome and the emperors loyal to the Catholic Bishop. One by one, the Catholic emperors overthrew these three rebel tribes.

Please note: scholars universally agree that this little Horn is in fact the Antichrist.

Revelation 13: 1-2… Note the characteristics of this beast as described by John in vision. Is this a hybrid of the previous beasts previously seen by the prophet Daniel perhaps?



Daniel 7: 25… Note how this little Horn speaks pompous words against the Most High. To find out more about what this actually means we now turn to **Rev 13: 5-6; John: 10: 33; Mark: 2: 1-7**.

Revelation 13: 5-6… We find here, that the beast/antichrist power is given a mouth speaking great things and blasphemies. **Question:** How does the Bible define Blasphemy?

John 10: 33… In the preceding dialogue, Jesus has just claimed to be God and the Pharisees are not very comfortable with that! So they took up stones in order to stone him. Then Jesus begins to question their motive? For which of my good works do you stone me?

The Pharisees reply, "it is not for a good work we are going to stone you, but for *blasphemy*! **Because you being a man, make yourself God"**.

Mark 2: 1-7… Notice the Pharisees are accusing Jesus of *Blasphemy* when **he claims the power to forgive sins!**

In summary, we find that when a man claims to be God when he is not God, or claims the power to forgive sin he is committing *blasphemy.* **(See appendices for examples).**

Further identification marks contained within ***Daniel 7: 25…***

- Shall persecute the saints.
- Change times and laws.
- Rule for a period of a time and times and half a time.

Note: A time in the bible is one year (a complete cycle of the seasons), a times is two years and half a time is half a year. Thus the time Daniel is referring to is 3.5 years.

Revelation 12: 6, 14… Note the correlation between the time periods of One thousand two hundred and sixty days in verse 6 with that of the time period given in verse 14 as a time and times and half a time.

Revelation 13: 5… Note the correlation between the Woman fleeing into the wilderness for a given period of time (1260days), and the beast power having its authority for a period of time (forty-two months).

Assuming a Jewish 360 day year/30 day month, all three of these time periods mentioned are in fact the same. Now, in the Bible a prophetic day is equal to a literal year.

Luke 13: 31-35… Note after Jesus has been warned of impending doom, his response is far from that of fear or regret. Rather, Jesus provides a counter response exuberating confidence stating that he will continue to perform his ministry today, tomorrow and the next day and only then shall he finish his course.

Question: How does Jesus define being perfected or finishing his course or reaching his goal? **(Dependant on version).**

Answer: Perishing (verse 33).

We must ask ourselves, why is Jesus so confident with his response? I mean he has just been given a legitimate warning to flee for his life! But Jesus new through the prophecy of Daniel 9 that his ministry would last for 3.5 years and only then shall he be brought to crucifixion. Here lies an example of Jesus' understanding of the day for year principle.

For further examples of the day for a year principle see ***Numbers 14: 34; Ezekiel 4:6.***

Now if we remember back to the year in which the historians depict the fall of Pagan Rome (A.D. 476) and the subsequent struggle for control of the remaining empire. In A. D. 533, Emperor Justinian decreed that the Bishop of Rome was to rule supreme over all the churches.
But this decree meant nothing until he and other Emperors were able to overthrow the three Arian tribes. (Heruli, Vandals & Ostrogoths)---"the three horns"

- The Emperor Zeno conquered the Heruli by encouraging the Ostrogoths to invade in A.D. 493.
- The Emperor Justinian sent his General Belisarius to conquer the Vandals in A.D. 534.
- General Belisarius then drove the Ostrogoths out of Rome in **A.D. 538.**

By A. D. 538, this was accomplished, and the era of the little Horns power had begun. The Papacy would continue in absolute power for another 1260 years till the year 1798. At that time the effects of the French Revolution resulted in a disruption of the power of the Roman Catholic Church, when General L. A. Berthier took Pope Pius VI into exile.

The antichrist kingdom: Ten identifying marks.

- A little kingdom.
- Arises from within the dividing nations of Rome.
- Uproots three kingdoms when it comes to power.
- Has a man at its head.
- Speaks blasphemy.
- *Thinks* to change Gods law.
- Persecutes God's people.
- Reigns for a period of 1260 years.
- Rises to power after A.D. 476 because the little Horn succeeded Pagan Rome.
- "It is different" from the others. They were state powers, and the little Horn is a "church-state" combination.



The only Kingdom/power that fits all of these characteristics is the Roman-Church State (Papal Rome).

*****For further details see appendix:**

Appendix:

The Antichrist

Ten Horns/ dividing nations of Europe:

New England Expositors Support Old World Positions.

Paralleling the Old World post-Reformation expositors, a stalwart line of interpreters of Dan. 7 appeared in New England, extending from Puritan John Cotton in 1639, on to pre-millennialist Joshua Spalding in 1796—a number of prominent writers. These comprised Presbyterians, Baptists, and other nonconformists. While the majority were clergymen, several were presidents of colleges—Harvard, Princeton, Yale, and others—from Increase Mather on to Timothy Dwight, in the early years of the 19th century. There were also governors, a chief justice of Massachusetts, a Postmaster General, and a Secretary of State, as well as physicians, historians, legislators, educators, authors, and editors.

Roger Williams' petition to the British Parliament for protection against religious persecution was based on the prophetic outline of Dan. 7. The high-water mark in Colonial exposition was doubtless in the time of Increase Mather (d. 1723), who wrote:

"It was revealed to the Prophet Daniel, that there should be Four great Monarchy's on the Earth successively; First, the Babylonish, after that the Persian, then the Grecian, and lastly the Roman: And that this should be divided into Ten Kingdoms; and that among them there should spring up an Horn (a King) which should be diverse from the other Kings, viz. Antichrist: All this has been fulfilled. But then 'tis foretold that this Horn should make War with the Saints and prevail over them, and continue for a Time, and Times, and the dividing of Time, and after that be destroyed, and then shall be given to CHRIST, Dominion, and Glory, and a Kingdom, (Dan. 7:14) that ALL People, Nations and Languages should fear Him"

These men designated the papacy, or the successive bishops of Rome and their followers, as the little horn upspringing among the divisions of Rome, which are frequently named. For instance, William Burnet (d. 1729) lists them as the Visigoths, Vandals, Franks, Burundians, Huns, Alans, Suevians, Heruli, Ostrogoths, and Lombard's, with the three horns plucked up being the Heruli, Ostrogoths, and Vandals. And in the fixing of the time feature, the 31/2 times, or 1260 years, range between Cotton's dating of 395–1655 on to Joseph Lathrop's 606–1866. So there was virtually parity with Old World interpretation of the same period.

Discourse Concerning Faith and Fervency in Prayer, p. 19



Ancient names of divided Europe and their current names:

Visigoths	**Spain**
Anglo-Saxons	**England**
Franks	**France**
Alemani	**Germany**
Burgundians	**Switzerland**
Lombards	**Italy**
Suevi	**Portugal**
Heruli	***Uprooted***
Ostrogoths	***Uprooted***
Vandals	***Uprooted***

"In 538AD, the year when the Ostrogoths collapsed, it was out of the smoking ruins of the western Roman Empire and after the overthrow of the three Arian kingdoms that the pope of Rome emerged as the most important single individual in the West, the head of a closely organized church with a carefully defined creed and with vast potential for political influence. Dozens of writers have pointed out that the real survivor of the ancient Roman Empire was the Church of Rome".

E.G. McKenzie, "Catholic Church" p. 14.

Please note: The fall of the three Arian kingdoms is not the prophetic marker associated with A.D. 538. Instead, the issue is the recognition of prophetic fulfilment in the rise into power of the little horn (the beast), primarily because of its prophesised attack against God's plan of salvation, His law and His people. An exhaustive study will reveal that not once do the primary sources of history and credible historians the world over declare that the Ostrogoths ceased to exist in the exact year of A.D. 538. Regarding the timing of the fall of the three horns, the Bible does not specify when they would be taken off the stage of action. It does imply that the last of the three horns (kingdoms) would be going down when the little Horn would be coming up into power.

History identifies this power:

The Book Titled "The History of the Christian Church" is not a religious manual; it is a secular historical account of the Christian Church. Note the following statement;

"The Roman Church States power became supreme in Christendom in AD 538 due to the letter of Roman Emperor Justinian, known as Justinian's decree which set up acknowledged the Bishop of Rome as the head of all churches. It gave the Roman Church State political power, civil power as well as ecclesiastical power. This letter became a part of Justinian's code, the fundamental law of the empire and that year pope Vigilius ascended the papal chair under the military protection of Belisarius."

History of the Christian Church, Vol. 3, p. 327.

"The transfer of the emperor's residence to Constantinople was a sad blow to the prestige of Rome, and at the time one might have predicted a speed decline, but the development of the Church and the growing authority of the Bishop of Rome, or the Pope, gave her a new lease of life and made her again the capital, the religious capital of the civilized world."

Abbot's Roman History, p236.

"To the succession of the Caesar's came the succession of the Pontiffs in Rome. When Constantine left Rome he gave his seat to the Pontiff."

Labianca, Professor of History, University of Rome.

Another little horn:

Better, "another horn, a little one." Though small at the beginning, this little horn is described later as "more stout than his fellows," literally, "greater than its companions." It will be seen that this was the continuation of the Roman power in the Roman Church. Note the following statement:

"Out of the ruins of political Rome, arose the great moral Empire in the 'giant form' of the Roman Church"

(A. C. Flick, The Rise of the Medieval Church [1900], p. 150). See further on vs. 24, 25.

"Under the Roman Empire the popes had no temporal powers. But when the Roman Empire had disintegrated and its place had been taken by a number of rude, barbarous kingdoms, the Roman Catholic Church not only became independent of the states in religious affairs but dominated secular affairs as well. At times, under such rulers as Charlemagne (768–814), Otto the Great (936–73), and Henry III (1039–56), the civil power controlled the church to some extent; but in general, under the

weak political system of feudalism, the well-organized, unified, and centralized church, with the pope at its head, was not only independent in ecclesiastical affairs but also controlled civil affairs"

(Carl Conrad Eckhardt, The Papacy and World-Affairs [1937], p. 1).

He shall speak pompous/Great words against the most High:

Consider this: Against: Aramaic renders: tsad and literally means "side." ṭṣad may be interpreted as meaning "over against," implying that in its opposition to the Most High the little horn would set itself up as being equal with God (see on 2 Thess. 2:4; cf. Isa. 14:12–14).

Ecclesiastical literature is replete with exhibits of the arrogant, blasphemous claims of the papacy. Typical examples are the following extracts from a large encyclopaedic work written by a Roman Catholic divine of the 18th century:

"The Pope is of so great dignity and so exalted that he is not a mere man, but as it were God, and the vicar of God. …

"The Pope is crowned with a triple crown, as king of heaven and of earth and of the lower regions. …

"The Pope is as it were God on earth, sole sovereign of the faithful of Christ, chief of kings, having plenitude of power, to whom has been entrusted by the omnipotent God direction not only of the earthly but also of the heavenly kingdom. …

"The Pope is of so great authority and power that he can modify, explain, or interpret even divine laws. …

"The Pope can modify divine law, since his power is not of man but of God, and he acts as vicegerent of God upon earth with most ample power of binding and losing his sheep.

"Whatever the Lord God himself, and the Redeemer, is said to do, that his vicar does, provided that he does nothing contrary to the faith"

(translated from Lucius Ferraris, "Papa II," Prompta Bibliotheca, Vol. VI, pp. 25–29).

Persecute /Wear out the saints of the Most High:

The event is earlier described in the words, "the same horn made war with the saints, and prevailed against them" (v. 21). The phrase depicts continuous and relentless persecution. The papacy acknowledges that it has persecuted, and defends such acts as a legitimate exercise of power presumably granted her by Christ. The following is from The Catholic Encyclopaedia:

"In the Bull 'Ad exstirpanda' (1252) Innocent IV says: 'When those adjudged guilty of heresy have been given up to the civil power by the bishop or his representative, or the Inquisition, the podestà or chief magistrate of the city shall take them at once, and shall, within five days at the most, execute the laws made against them.' … Nor could any doubt remain as to what civil regulations were meant, for the passages which ordered the burning of impenitent heretics were inserted in the papal decretals from the imperial constitutions 'Commissis nobis' and 'Inconsutibilem tunicam.' The aforesaid Bull 'Ad exstirpanda' remained thenceforth a fundamental document of the Inquisition, renewed or re-enforced by several popes, Alexander IV (1254–61), Clement IV (1265–68), Nicholas IV (1288–92), Boniface VIII (1294–1303), and others. The civil authorities, therefore, were enjoined by the popes, under pain of excommunication to execute the legal sentences that condemned impenitent heretics to the stake"

(Joseph Blötzer, art. "Inquisition," Vol. VIII, p. 34).

Three of the first horns (538):

The "little horn" is a symbol of papal Rome. Hence the plucking up of three horns symbolizes the overthrow of three of the barbarian nations. Among the principal obstructions to the rise of papal Rome to political power were the Heruli, the Vandals, and the Ostrogoths. All three were supporters of Arianism, which was the most formidable rival of Catholicism.

The Heruli were the first of the barbarian tribes to rule over Rome. They were German auxiliary troops in Rome who mutinied, and in 476 deposed the boy Romulus Augustus, the last emperor of the West. At the head of the Heruli and the other mercenary troops was Odovacar (Odoacer), who made himself king in Rome. Odovacar, an Arian, though tolerant toward the Catholics, was hated by the Italians. At the suggestion of the Emperor Zeno of the Eastern Empire, Theodoric, leader of the Ostrogoths, next invaded Italy. He arrived there in 489, and in 493 secured Odovacar's surrender and soon afterward killed him **(see Thomas Hodgkin, Italy and Her Invaders, vol. 3, pp. 180–213).**

So far as the position of the Roman Church was concerned the arrival of Theodoric marked no change for the better, but merely a change of leaders. Theodoric was as strong an Arian as his predecessor on the throne of Italy. Although he granted toleration to the various religions in his kingdom, the lofty ambitions of the Roman pontiff could not succeed under a system that granted only toleration.

In the meantime the Vandals, led by Gaiseric (Genseric), had settled in North Africa, having taken Carthage in 439. Being fanatically Arian and warlike, they posed a threat to the supremacy of the

Catholic Church in the West. They were particularly intolerant toward the Catholics, whom they termed heretics. To help the cause of the Catholics in the West the Emperor Justinian, who ruled the Eastern half of the Roman Empire in Constantinople, dispatched Belisarius, the ablest of his generals. Belisarius completely vanquished the Vandals in 534.

This victory left the Ostrogoths in Italy as the sole surviving Arian power of significance to hinder the hegemony of the papacy in the West **(see Hodgkin, op. cit., vol. 3, ch. 15).** Having wiped out the Vandals, Belisarius in 534 began his campaign against the Ostrogoths in Italy. Though this campaign lasted for twenty years before the imperial armies emerged completely victorious **(see Hodgkin, op. cit., vol. 5, pp. 3–66),** the decisive action occurred early in the campaign. The Ostrogoths, who had been driven from Rome, returned and laid siege to it in 537. The siege lasted for a full year, but in 538 Justinian landed another army in Italy, and in March the Ostrogoths abandoned the siege **(see Hodgkin, op. cit., vol. 4, pp. 73–113, 210–252; Charles Diehl, "Justinian," in Cambridge Medieval History, vol. 2, p. 15).** It is true that they re-entered the city for a very brief time in 540, but their stand was short-lived. Their withdrawal from Rome in 538 marked the real end of Ostrogothic power, though not of the Ostrogothic nation. Thus was "plucked up" the third of the three horns that stood in the way of the little horn.

Justinian is noted not only for his success in temporarily reuniting Italy and parts of the West with the Eastern half of what had been the Roman Empire, but also for the gathering and organizing of the then-existing laws of the empire, including new edicts of Justinian himself, into a unified code. Incorporated into this imperial code were two official letters of Justinian, which had all the force of royal edicts, in which he legally confirmed the bishop of Rome as the "head of all the holy churches" and "head of all the holy priests of God" **(Code of Justinian, book 1, title 1).** In the later epistle he also commends the pope's activities as corrector of heretics.

Although this legal recognition of the pope's ecclesiastical supremacy was dated in 533, it is obvious that the imperial edict could not become effective for the pope so long as the Arian Ostrogothic kingdom was in control of Rome and the greater part of Italy. Not until the rule of the Goths was broken could the papacy be free to develop fully its power. In AD 538, for the first time since the end of the Western imperial line, the city of Rome was freed from the domination of an Arian kingdom. In that year the Ostrogothic kingdom received its deathblow (although the Ostrogoths survived some years longer as a people). That is why 538 is a more significant date than 533.

To summarize: (1) The pope had already been recognized generally (though by no means universally) as supreme bishop in the churches of the West, and had exercised considerable political influence, from time to time, under the patronage of the Western emperors. (2) In 533 Justinian recognized the pope's ecclesiastical supremacy as "head of all the holy churches" in both East and West, and this legal recognition was incorporated into the imperial code of laws (534). (3) In 538 the papacy was effectively freed from the domination of the Arian kingdoms that followed the Western emperors in the control of Rome and Italy. From then on the papacy was in a position to increase its

ecclesiastical power. The other kingdoms became Catholic, one by one, and since the distant Eastern emperors did not retain control of Italy, in the turbulent developments that followed, the pope emerged often as the leading figure in the West. The papacy acquired territorial rule and eventually it reached its peak in political as well as religious dominance in Europe. Though this dominance came much later, the turning point can be found in the time of Justinian.

Some find it significant that Vigilius, the pope who held office in 538, had, the year before, replaced a pope who had been under Gothic influence. The new pope owed his office to the Empress Theodora, and was regarded by Justinian as the means of uniting all the churches, East and West, under his own imperial dominance. It has been pointed out that, beginning with Vigilius, the popes were more and more men of the state as well as of the church, and often became rulers of the state.

Charles Bemont and G. Monod, Medieval Europe, p. 121.

Papacy, Plans of the French to Destroy (1798):

The object of the French directory was the destruction of the pontifical government, as the irreconcilable enemy of the republic… The aged pope [Pius VI] was summoned to surrender the temporal government; on his refusal, he was dragged from the altar… His rings were torn from his fingers, and finally, after declaring the temporal power abolished, the victors carried the pope prisoner into Tuscany, whence he never returned (1798).

The Papal States, converted into the Roman Republic, were declared to be in perpetual alliance with France, but the French general was the real master at Rome… The territorial possessions of the clergy and monks were declared national property, and their former owners cast into prison. The papacy was extinct: not a vestige of its existence remained; and among all the Roman Catholic powers not a finger was stirred in its defence. The Eternal City had not longer prince or pontiff; its bishop was a dying captive in foreign lands; and the decree was already announced that no successor would be allowed in his place.

Source: George Trevor, Rome: From the Fall of the Western Empire (London: The Religious Tract Society, 1868), pp. 439, 440.

"In 1798 General Berthier made his entrance into Rome, abolished the papal government, and established a secular one."

Encyclopaedia Britannica 1941 edition.

Papacy — Pope, Captivity of (1798)—Exile (Feb. 20) and Death (1799):

The time, however, was arrived, when it became more desirable to send him [the Pope] entirely out of the way, in order that his effects might be disposed of with a better grace… it was decreed that he should go; and on the morning of the 20th of February, about seven o'clock, he left Rome, accompanied by three coaches of his own suite, and a body of French cavalry, to escort him safe into Tuscany; and on the 25th arrived at Siena, where he was requested to remain till further orders. Here he was received into the monastery of S. Barbara of the order of S. Augustin, whose members sorrowfully welcomed him at the gate, and offered all that their Convent could bestow, to console him under his misfortunes.

An earthquake having taken place at Siena in the month of May, the Pope was removed to a Carthusian Convent within two miles of Florence…He was suffered to remain in the Carthusian Convent until the 27th of March, 1799. He was then removed to Parma; from whence he was conducted to Briancon in France, and afterward to Valence, where he died on the 29th of August of the same year.

Source: R[ichard] Duppa, A Brief Account of the Subversion of the Papal Government. 1798 (3d ed., London: John Murray, 1807), pp. 50–52, 54.

Papal Claims to be God on Earth:

"The Pope is not simply the representative of Jesus Christ. On the contrary, he is Jesus Christ Himself, under the veil of the flesh, and who by means of a being common to humanity continues His ministry amongst men ... Does the Pope speak? It is Jesus Christ Who is speaking. Does he teach? It is Jesus Christ Who teaches. Does he confer grace or pronounce an anathema? It is Jesus Christ Himself Who is pronouncing the anathema and conferring the grace. Hence consequently, when one speaks of the Pope, it is not necessary to examine, but to obey: there must be no limiting the bounds of the command, in order to suit the purpose of the individual whose obedience is demanded: there must be no cavilling at the declared will of the Pope, and so invest it with quite another than that which he has put upon it: no preconceived opinions must be brought to bear upon it: no rights must be set up against the rights of the Holy Father to teach and command;

his decisions are not to be criticized, or his ordinances disputed. Therefore by Divine ordination, all, no matter how august the person may be — whether he wear a crown or be invested with the purple, or be clothed in the sacred vestments: all must be subject to Him Who has had all things put under Him."

Evangelical Christendom, January 1, 1895, pg. 15, published in London by J. S. Phillips.

"In founders and foundresses [of the consecrated orders of nuns and priests, etc.] we see a constant and lively sense of the Church, which they manifest by their full participation in all aspects of the Church's life, and in their ready obedience to the bishops and especially to the Roman Pontiff.

Against this background of love towards Holy Church, 'the pillar and bulwark of the truth' (1 Tim 3:15), we readily understand the devotion of Saint Francis of Assisi for 'THE LORD POPE', the daughterly outspokenness of Saint Catherine of Siena towards the one whom she called 'SWEET CHRIST ON EARTH', the apostolic obedience and the sentire cum Ecclesia of Saint Ignatius Loyola, and the joyful profession of faith made by Saint Teresa of Avila: 'I am a daughter of the Church'. We can also understand the deep desire of Saint Theresa of the Child Jesus: 'In the heart of the Church, my mother, I will be love'.

These testimonies are representative of the full ecclesial communion whom the Saints, founders and foundresses, have shared in diverse and often difficult times and circumstances. They are examples which consecrated persons need constantly to recall if they are to resist the particularly strong centrifugal and disruptive forces at work today. A distinctive aspect of ecclesial communion is allegiance of mind and heart to the magisterium of the bishops, an allegiance which must be lived honestly and clearly testified to before the People of God by all consecrated persons, especially those involved in theological research, teaching, publishing, catechesis and the use of the means of social communication. Because consecrated persons have a special place in the church, their attitude in this regard is of immense importance for the whole people of God"

Pope John Paul II, "Apostolic Exhortation on the Consecrated Life and Its Mission in the Church and in the World," to the bishops and clergy, religious orders and congregations, societies of apostolic life, secular institutes, and all the faithful, given in Rome, at Saint Peter's, March 25, 1996.

"It seems that Pope John Paul II now presides over the **universal Church** from his place upon Christ's cross," said Bishop Dunn, who travelled with seven other prelates to Rome.

Taken from an article entitled, "Auckland Bishop Says Pope Presides From the Cross" AUCKLAND, New Zealand, SEPT. 20, 2004 -Zenit.org (Article # ZE04092001)
(Also note the term "Universal Church" is now being used!)

*"*The Pope is of so great dignity, and so exalted that he is not a mere man, but as it were God, and the vicar of God."

Ferraris Ecclesiastical dictionary

"All names which in the Scriptures are applied to Christ, by virtue of which it is established that He is over the church, all the same names are applied to the Pope."

On the Authority of the Councils, book 2, chapter 17

"The Pope and God are the same, so he has all power in Heaven and earth."

Pope Pius V, quoted in Barclay, Chapter XXVII, p. 218, "Cities Petrus Bertanous".

"The Pope is as it were God on earth, sole sovereign of the faithful of Christ, chief of kings, having plenitude of power."

Lucius Ferraris, in "Prompta Bibliotheca Canonica, Juridica, Moralis, Theologica, Ascetica, Polemica, Rubristica, Historica", Volume V, article on "Papa, Article II", titled "Concerning the extent of Papal dignity, authority, or dominion and infallibility", #1, 5, 13-15, 18, published in Petit-Montrouge (Paris) by J. P. Migne, 1858 edition.

"The Pope takes the place of Jesus Christ on earth...by divine right the Pope has supreme and full power in faith, in morals over each and every pastor and his flock. He is the true vicar, the head of the entire church, the father and teacher of all Christians. He is the infallible ruler, the founder of dogmas, the author of and the judge of councils; the universal ruler of truth, the arbiter of the world, the supreme judge of heaven and earth, the judge of all, being judged by no one, being God himself on earth."

Quoted in the New York Catechism.

These words appeared in the Roman Canon Law: "To believe that our Lord God the Pope has not the power to decree as he is decreed, is to be deemed heretical.

The Gloss "Extravagantes" o.f Pope John XXII Cum inter, *Tit. XIV, Cap. IV. Ad Callem Sexti Decretalium, Paris,* 1685.

Father A. Pereira says: "It is quite certain that Popes have never approved or rejected this title 'Lord God the Pope,' for the passage in the gloss referred to *appears in the edition of the Canon Law published in Rome in 1580 by Gregory XIII."*Writers on the Canon Law say, "The Pope and God are the same, so he has all power in heaven and earth."

Barclay Cap. XXVII, p. 218. *Cities Petrus Bertrandus,* Pius V. - *Cardinal Cusa supports his statement.*

Pope Nicholas I declared that "the appellation of God had been confirmed by Constantine on the Pope, who, being God, cannot be judged by man."

Labb *IX Dist.:* 96 Can. 7, *Satis evidentur, Decret Gratian Primer Para.*

"The pope is of so great dignity and so exalted that he is not a mere man, he is as it were God on earth, sole sovereign of the faithful of Christ, chief of kings, having plenitude of power."

Lucius Ferraris, «Prompta Bibliotheca», 1763, Volume VI, 'Papa II', pp.25-29.

"The supreme teacher in the Church is the Roman Pontiff. Union of minds, therefore, requires complete submission and obedience of will to the Church and to the Roman Pontiff, as to God Himself."

Leo VIII, «On the Chief Duties of Christians as Citizens», Encyclical letter, 1890.

"God separates those whom the Roman Pontiff, who exercises the functions, not of mere man, but of the true God dissolves, not by human but rather by divine authority."

Decretals of Gregory IX», Book 1, Chapter 7.3.

"Hence the Pope is crowned with a triple crown, as king of heaven and of earth and of the lower regions (infernorum)."

Lucius Ferraris, «Prompta Bibliotheca», 1763, Volume VI, 'Papa II', p.26.

"Innocent III has written: "Indeed, it is not too much to say that in view of the sublimity of their offices the priests are so many gods."

The dignity of the priesthood by Liguori p, 36.

"The Pope is not only the representative of Jesus Christ, he is Jesus Christ himself, hidden under the veil of flesh."

Catholic National July 1895.

"We hold upon this earth the place of God Almighty"

Pope Leo XIII Encyclical Letter of June 20, 1894.

"For thou art the shepherd, thou art the physician, thou art the director, thou art the husbandman, finally thou art another God on earth."

Labbe and Cossart's "History of the Councils." Vol. XIV, col. 109.

The title "*Lord God the Pope*" is found within a gloss of *Extravagantes of Pope John XXII*, title 14, chapter 4.

In an Antwerp edition of the *Extravagantes*, the words, *"Dominum Deum Nostrum Papam"* (Our Lord God the Pope) can be found in column 153. In a Paris edition, they are found in column 140.

Roman Catholic Canon Law stipulates through Pope Innocent III that the Roman pontiff is "the vicegerent upon earth, not a mere man, but of a very God;" and in a gloss on the passage it is explained that this is because he is the vicegerent of Christ, who is "very God and very man."

Decretales Domini Gregorii translatione Episcoporum, (on the transference of Bishops), title 7, chapter 3; Corpus Juris Canonice (2nd Leipzig ed., 1881), col. 99; (Paris, 1612), tom. 2, Devretales, col. 205.

"The pope is the supreme judge of the law of the land... He is the vicegerent (replacement) of Christ, who is not only a Priest forever, but also King of kings and Lord of lords."

La Civilia Cattolica, March 18, 1871, quoted in Leonard Woosely Bacaon, An inside view of the Vatican Council (American Tract Society ed.), p.229.

The last line of the 1302 ad Bull Unam Sanctam... Issued by POPE BONIFACE VIII states; we declare, we proclaim, we define that it is absolutely necessary for salvation that every human creature be subject to the Roman Pontiff.

UNAM SANCTAM (Promulgated November 18, 1302) (For a complete look at this quote, see this... http://www.fordham.edu/halsall/source/b8-unam.html or this... http://www.papalencyclicals.net/Bon08/B8unam.htm)

"Christ entrusted His office to the chief pontiff;... but all power in heaven and in earth has been given to Christ;... therefore the chief pontiff, who is His vicar, will have this power."

Corpus Juris chap. 1 column 29, translated from a gloss on the words Porro Subesse Romano Pontiff.

"All the faithful must believe that the Holy Apostolic See and the Roman Pontiff [the Pope] possesses the primacy over the whole world, and the Roman Pontiff is the successor of blessed Peter, Prince of the Apostles, and is true vicar of Christ, and heed of the whole church, and father

and teacher of all Christians; and that full power was given to him in blessed Peter to rule, feed, and govern the universal Church by Jesus Christ our Lord."

First Dogmatic Constitution on the Church of Christ, "Eternal Pastor," published in the fourth session of the Vatican Council, 1870, chap. 3, in Philip Schaff, Creeds of Christendom. vol. 2, p. 262.

"The Saviour Himself is the door of the sheepfold: 'I am the door of the sheep.' Into this fold of Jesus Christ, no man may enter unless he be led by the Sovereign Pontiff; and only if they be united to him can men be saved, for the Roman Pontiff is the Vicar of Christ and His personal representative on earth."

Pope John XXIII in his homily to the Bishops and faithful assisting at his coronation on November 4, 1958.

"This is our last lesson to you: receive it, engrave it in your minds, all of you: by God's commandment salvation is to be found nowhere but in the Church; the strong and effective instrument of salvation is none other than the Roman Pontificate."

Pope Leo XIII, Allocution for the 25th anniversary of his election, February 20, 1903; Papal Teachings: The Church, Benedictine Monks of Solesmes, St. Paul Editions, Boston, 1962, par. 653.

"Furthermore, in this one Church of Christ no man can be or remain who does not accept, recognize and obey the authority and supremacy of Peter and his legitimate successors."

Pope Pius XI, Encyclical, Mortalium animos, January 6, 1928, The Papal Encyclicals, Claudia Carlen, I.H.M., McGrath Publishing Co., 1981, pp. 317, 318.

"We define that the Holy Apostolic See (the Vatican) and the Roman Pontiff hold the primacy over the whole world."

A Decree of the Council of Trent, quoted in Philippe Labbe and Gabriel Cossart, "The Most Holy Councils," col. 1167.

"Of what sublime dignity is the office of the Christian priest who is thus privileged to act as the ambassador and the vicegerent of Christ on earth! He continues the essential ministry of Christ; he teaches the faithful with the authority of Christ, he pardons the penitent sinner with the power of Christ, he offers up again the same sacrifice of adoration and atonement which Christ offered on Calvary. No wonder that the name which spiritual writers are especially fond of applying to the priest is that of 'alter Christus.' For the priest is and should be another Christ."

Faith of Millions, John O'Brien, Ph.D., LL.D., 268-269, "nihil obstat" by Rev. T. E. Dillon-Censor Librorum and "imprimatur" by John Francis Noll, D.D. -Bishop of Fort Wayne.

Popes and Priests declare they can forgive the sins of men:

"And God himself is obliged to abide by the judgment of his priest and either not to pardon or to pardon, according as they refuse to give absolution, provided the penitent is capable of it."

Liguori, «Duties and Dignities of the Priest», p.27.

"This judicial authority will even include the power to forgive sin."

The Catholic Encyclopaedia Vol xii, article 'Pope' pg 265.

"The poor sinner kneels at his confessor's feet. He KNOWS he is not speaking to an ordinary man but to 'ANOTHER CHRIST,' He hears the words: 'I absolve thy sins..." and the HIDEOUS LOAD OF SINS DROPS FROM HIS SOUL FOREVER."

William Doyle "Shall I be a priest" pp 14, 15.

Bible marking points for The Antichrist study.

Prepare to write in your Bible:

Daniel 7...

- Next to verse 3, write Vs 17, 23.
- Next to verse 4, write Babylon (605-539bc).
- Next to verse 5, write Medo Persia (539-331bc).
- Also next to verse 5, write Babylon, Lydia & Egypt.
- Next to verse 6, write Greece (331-168bc).
- Also next to verse 6, write Cassander, Lysimachus, Seleucus & Ptolemy.
- Next to verse 7, write Rome (168bc-476ad).
- In verse 8, mark & number the major identifying characteristics within the text:
    - A little Horn.
    - Among them.
    - Plucked.
    - Eyes.
    - Mouth.

Now in verse 25 we will do the same thing:

- Pompous words.
- Persecute the saints.
- Change times & laws.
- A time, times & half a time.

Now back in verse 8, write near to where it says “three of the first Horns were plucked out by the roots”…

- Heruli - 493ad.
- Vandals – 534ad.
- Ostrogoths – 538ad.

In verse 25, next to “He shall speak pompous words” write the following:

- Revelation 13: 5, 6.
- John 10: 33.
- Mark 2: 1-7.

And in verse 25, next to where it says “For a time and times and half a time” write the following:

- Revelation 12: 6, 14.
- Revelation 13: 5.
- Luke 13: 31- 35.
- Numbers 14: 34.
- Ezekiel 4: 6.